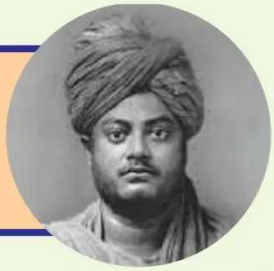
Chapter 7

THE MIGHTY MARATHAS

As forest-fire is to the forest trees, a leopard to the deer-herds and a lion to the stately elephants; as the sun is to the darkness of the night, as Krishna was to Kansa, so was king Shivaji, a lion, towards the hordes of Mlechchas.

- Swami Vivekananda



LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Explain the context in which the Marathas rose to become a significant power in Bharat
- Assess the political, governance and security systems of the Marathas
- Indicate the impact of great saints on the Maratha empire
- Discuss the charisma and acumen of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj - one of the greatest rulers of Bharat

INTRODUCTION

The early part of the history of the Marathas can be traced to the Bhonsales starting with Maloji, Shahaji and the most popular Shivaji. The Bhonsales descended from the Sisodia Ranas of Chittor and Udaipur. The Marathas were simple, straightforward, courageous and self-reliant people. They fought against the oppressive Mughal and Deccan rulers. Skilled in guerilla warfare, and great possessing love for their motherland made the Marathas scale great heights.

The Marathas were inspired by religious and social leaders like Eknathji, Guru Samartha Ramdas and Sant Tukaram. The torch bearer of the Marathas was the brave and brilliant Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, one of the greatest leaders that Bharat has seen. Born during peak of Mughal aggression he fought against them and established Hindavi Swarajya, an independent and self-ruled mighty Maratha empire. When the name of Shivaji is uttered, it evokes courage and honour in the people of Bharat even today.

SCENARIO IN BHARAT

In 1627 CE most parts of Bharat were invaded by the Mughals. As the invaders brought in new rules to suit them, tens of thousands of natives were displaced from their ancestral homes, religious conversions were forced on people, temples and monuments of faith were looted and disfigured.

Shah Jahan took over as the emperor of the Mughal empire post Jahangir. He ruled the Deccan region through Sultan Adil Shah at Bijapur and Sultan Qutb Shah at Golconda. The Mughals preferred their officers to be Muslims. However sending such officers to the Deccan provinces was a challenge. The land routes were filled with their enemies and the sea routes were controlled by the Portuguese.The Mughals were forced to choose some trusted Hindu officers for their army.

Maloji Bhonsale was a Maratha Sardar who served as a horseman under the Ahmednagar Sultanate and rose to become a general. He had two sons Shahaji and Sharifji. **Shahaji Raje Bhonsale** became a top commander in Adil Shah's troops and Jagirdar (chieftain) of Pune & Supa. He married **Jijabai**, another Hindu general's daughter. Jijabai carried in her a bright flame of Hindu independence. Moving with her husband from one battle to another, Jijabai developed a fighting and resilient spirit. On 19 February 1630 at the fort of Shivneri, Pune they were blessed with a son, Shivaji.

EARLY YEARS OF SHIVAJI MAHARAJ

One of the greatest influencers in the life of Shivaji was his mother Jijabai, a pious and religious woman. She inspired him with stories from the Ramayana, Mahabharata, Puranas and tales of heroic kings. She instilled in him all the values required for a great leader.

JIJABAI FINDS THE WARRIOR IN HER SON

When he was a toddler, Jijabai left Shivaji in a room filled with various toys. Any other kid of his age would have picked up an attractive toy, but Shivaji was no ordinary child. He chose a wooden sword. The surprised Jijabai again experimented by re-arranging the sword amongst other toys the next day. Again, the child amazed his mother by searching and picking the sword. When Jijabai removed the sword from the room, the little child refused to choose anything else. Jijabai spotted the spirit of the warrior in Shivaji very early in life.

Shivaji spent his early life at the Shivneri Fort under the tutelage of his uncle **Dadoji Kondadeo**, who managed the province in the absence of his father. He was a strict disciplinarian and role model to Shivaji. Dadoji taught the young Shivaji about techniques of warfare and theories of good administration.


Jijabai and Shivaji

Although Shahaji spent his military life serving the Deccan Sultanates, Shivaji broke away from his father's path with the vision of **Hindavi Swarajya** - self rule of Bharat by Bharatiyas.

OATH OF INDEPENDENCE

Shivaji did not have brothers and sisters for company. From a very early age, he learnt to be independent. He grew up with friends who came from the hilly regions and were hardy and strong. Once the teenager Shivaji trekked up to the Raireshwar temple with his friends. It was a challenging one but they made it to the top.

With a sense of accomplishment, the young Shivaji declared:

> "Friends, now our path is clear. We shall all strive to attain our aim and work for it until it is achieved. We will have our own rule, our own kingdom. It will be yours, mine and everybody's kingdom. We refuse to live as slaves anymore. Let us take this oath with Lord Raireshwar as witness as we give ourselves completely to the great task of establishing our own Raj. God thinks that this kingdom should take shape as 'Hindavi Swarajya'. We shall ensure that God's wish is fulfilled."

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

Memorize the oath of independence taken by Shivaji. Form teams, randomly pick a few people from the team and ask them to recite the oath.

THE BUDDING LEADER



Shivaji had been trained in martial arts and civil administration. He gathered around him a band of officers who were loyal. In 1646, he strategically found a place that was away from the imperial* power centers and established his Rajya (kingdom) with the local peasants 'Mavlis' as his subjects. It was just a start.

Shivaji had extensive knowledge about the area where he was to fight battles. He knew every mountain, hillock, river, rivulet, fort and valley in the Deccan area like the back of his hand. His soldiers had detailed maps of the terrain. Shivaji understood the important role forts played in establishing an empire. Forts are a show of strength and protection. But how can he build forts from scratch? Shivaji snatched the Torna, Chakan and Kondan forts from Adilshah's commanders. He fought and won over Thane, Kalyan and Bhiwandi Forts with the help of **Abhaji Sondev**.

ADIL SHAH'S ANXIETY

No one had dared to challenge the sultans before. Now Adil Shah felt threatened. To stop this fearless teenager, Adil Shah arrested his own general Shahaji Bhonsale, Shivaji's father. Adil Shah was able to avert* attacks from Shivaji for the next 7 years. While the Mughals thought their problems were over, but Shivaji was gathering support from other patriots and strengthening his army without getting noticed. He steadily built a powerful army commanded by **Nethaji Palkar** and an infantry unit led by **Nethaji Kank**. He attacked and captured over 40 forts.



The warriors that Shivaji led were older and more experienced than him. Yet they followed him with faith and delivered their best. He was able to communicate his noble vision and infuse dynamism in these veterans. Imagine what a leader Shivaji must have been!

SHIVAJI'S UNIQUE MILITARY TACTICS

COMPETENT SPY NETWORK

Shivaji had a very competent spy network to gather information. Some of his loyal and brilliant spies were **Vishvasrao Nanaji Dige**, **Bahirji Naik**, **Sunderji Prabhuji**. Bahirji's information on the massive wealth and riches stored in Surat prompted Shivaji to attack the city and humiliate the Mughals. In fact, Bahirji had mapped out the entire city of Surat to help Shivaji's troops plunder the Mughal city in 1664.

GUERILLA WARFARE

Shivaji's army was adept in guerilla warfare. The army used unusual and out of the box ways to fight the enemy in treacherous* terrain. Shivaji understood that most of his foes had large armies. While he didn't have as many number of people in his army, he used unique tactics to ensure his smaller army was able to effectively win over the enemy.

Imperial : Royal/regal **Avert :** Avoid/fend off **Treacherous :** dangerous/ tough

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

What are the traits of a good spy? How should the king interact with his spies?

EXPANSION OF THE MARATHA EMPIRE

Shivaji established Hindavi Swaraj by conquering Adil Shah's Bijapur. Adil Shah failed in many attempts to subdue Shivaji and take back the kingdom. Finally, he sent his best and most powerful Afghani general, Afzal Khan, to kill Shivaji.

SHIVAJI VS AFZAL KHAN

Afzal Khan commanded a large force. This included 20,000 Adilshahi cavalry, 15,000 infantries, 10,000 of Afzal Khan's personal cavalry, 5,000 of personal infantry and 1,500 musketeers. The army also included close to 100 cannons, 90 elephants and over 1,000 camels. To provoke Shivaji to reveal himself, Afzal Khan looted and destroyed many temples including Tuljapur and Pandharpur temples and harmed innocent people. Tuljapur Bhavani was the ancestral deity of Shivaji. Shivaji understood Afzal Khan's intentions. He refused to fall for the trap. He knew that the opponents were mightier in numbers and he would lose if he fought in the plains. He wanted to play to his strengths. Shivaji sent a messenger to Afzal Khan, calling for a peace treaty.

AGREEMENT FOR THE MEETING

They will meet at Pratapgadh - a hill fort built on a spur* in the middle of thick jungles, valleys, rivers, at a height of 3,540 ft above sea level. Both parties will meet unarmed. They will come with only 10 guards. 1 guard would wait outside the tent where the meeting was to take place. 9 guards would be within arrow-shot distance.

Afzal Khan agreed to the meeting, thinking that this would be the right opportunity for him to kill Shivaji. But the clever Shivaji foresaw that the cunning Afzal Khan would double-cross him. Shivaji not only planned to kill Afzal Khan, but also defeat his entire army. Shivaji spoke to his people explaining the large risk of the plan unfolding before them. He instructed various parts of his army and administrators to be prepared for any eventuality so that the fight for Swarajya can continue.

Shivaji instructed all his soldiers to hide in the forests and wait for the sound of the canon and only then attack Afzal Khan's army. So, the Maratha soldiers went into the forests in small batches over many days and lived on the wild berries and fruits available there.

On 10 November 1659, the two met in a tent outside the Pratapgadh fort. Shivaji wore an armour, concealing a dagger and his famous **Wagnak** (Tiger-Claw) beneath it. As the two men entered the tent, the 6'7'' tall Afzal Khan tried to strangle Shivaji in an embrace and pierced his dagger into Shivaji's back. The armour under Shivaji's clothes saved him. He quickly thrust his tiger-claws into Afzal Khan's stomach and tore it apart, killing him instantly.



Pratapgadh fort

Shivaji escaped through the back, found his way to the top of the fort and he then sounded the canon. The

Spur : Piece of land that stick out between valleys

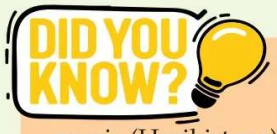


soldiers descended on Afzal Khan's army like a swarm and caught them by surprise. Adil Shah faced his worst defeat – he lost his artillery, 65 elephants, 4,000 horses, 1,000 camels, jewels worth Rs.3,00,000 and money worth Rs.10,00,000, heaps of precious clothes, and tents to the Marathas. He also lost the money and grain stored for feeding his army. 5,000 of Adil Shah's soldiers were killed. Almost as many were wounded. 3,000 soldiers were imprisoned. The remainder were allowed to go home in defeat. The Marathas lost only 1,734 soldiers, while 420 soldiers were wounded. Within 15 days of the battle of Pratapgadh, Shivaji had doubled his territory.

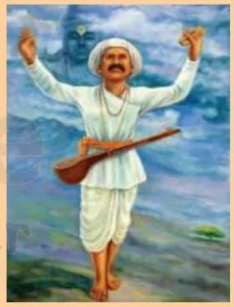
Shivaji's vision was Hindavi Swaraj or self-rule. His fight was against foreign invaders. This vision enabled his troops and citizens to work together more effectively. His vision led him to capture and build 360 forts. Shivaji once said, "Even if the foreign enemy takes a year to acquire one fort, it would take them 360 years to win over us."

Shivaji was a constant thorn in the flesh of the sultans of Bijapur and the Adilshahis. His dynamism and bravery not only terrified the enemy, but also ignited the spirit of sacrifice in his followers.

BATTLE OF PRATAPGADH	
When?	November 1659 CE
Where?	Satara, Maharashtra
Who were the combatants?	
Marathas	Bijapur Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Shivaji	Afzal Khan
Outcome : Shivaji killed Afzal Khan, Mughal resources and wealth gained by the Marathas, Shivaji doubled his territory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Marathas became a formidable force in Deccan.	



Shivaji's bravery and love for Bharat is known to many. But did you know that Shivaji was very fond of devotional music (Harikirtana). Being very passionate about Sanatana Dharma he attended many pravachans* given by great saints like Santh Tukaram.



Sant Tukaram was a great devotee of Lord Vitthala and a significant part of the Varkari tradition. He followed the path popularized by Jnaneshwarji. Deeply immersed in the teachings of Santh Tukaram, Shivaji expressed his desire to become Tukaram's disciple. Tukaram understood the prevailing situation in Bharat and the need for rulers like Shivaji. He provided a strong spiritual message to Shivaji and directed the king towards a guru like Samartha Ramdas. He reminded Shivaji about his vision for Bharat and encouraged him to serve his people by leading them as a king.

BATTLE OF PAWANKIND

On hearing about Shivaji's presence inside Panhala fort (Panhalgadh), Adil Shah II despatched a large army, of more than 40,000 soldiers and cannons, to capture Shivaji (Panhalgadh is close to present day Kolhapur). His uncle Siddhi Jauhar led the army. Huge stores of grains inside the fort's granaries kept Shivaji and his people well fed for over 5 months. But the risk of Shivaji's capture was very high. With all supplies to the fort cut off by the Adilshahi army, something had to be done.

Shivaji along with his commander-in-chief **Baji Prabhu Deshpande**, intelligence chief **Bahirji Naik**, and his personal barber **Shiva Kashid** devised a plan to escape from Panhalgadh to another fort, Vishalgadh, 70kms away. It was monsoon time and Shivaji wanted to use the rains that masked sound and movement. Bahirji Naik mapped a lesser-known route and Baji Prabhu Deshpande hand-picked 600 soldiers to accompany Shivaji to Vishalgadh. What was Shivaji's personal barber Shiva Kashid going to do? Shiva Kashid very closely resembled Shivaji. It was decided by Baji Prabhu and Bahirji that Shiva Kashid would disguise himself

Pravachans : Spiritual lectures

as Shivaji and travel in a palanquin with a small group of soldiers on the route frequented by the enemy so as to distract them, while Shivaji's team escaped via the route proposed by Bahirji. Shivaji was not keen as he didn't want to put Shiva Kashid's life at risk. However Shiva Kashid was enthusiastic to serve his king and convinced Shivaji of the plan.

The two groups slipped out of the fort and raced towards Vishalgadh. Siddhi Jauhar's soldiers spotted a palanquin with a small group of soldiers and captured the group. The captured Shiva Kashid was paraded before Siddhi Jauhar and other captured Maratha soldiers to confirm his identity. But Siddhi Jauhar was still doubtful. In a few hours, Siddhi received news that a large contingent of more than 500 soldiers were headed towards Vishalgadh. Siddhi Jauhar understood that he was tricked and ordered Shiva Kashid to be beheaded and sent a large contingent of his army to pursue Shivaji. The large force of almost 10,000 quickly caught up with Shivaji's small force of around 600 soldiers. Baji Prabhu Deshpande decided that a smaller contingent of 300 soldiers will stay back to control the oncoming hordes while Shivaji will proceed with the rest to Vishalgadh. It was important for Shivaji to reach safety so that the fight for Swarajya can carry on.



Path from Panhalgadh to Vishalgadh


Baji Prabhu Deshpande

Baji Prabhu Deshpande with his determined troop of 300 brave warriors chose the narrow pass in the mountains called **Ghod Khind** (Horse Pass) to encounter the raiding hordes of Adil Shah. Ghod Khind was a very strategic choice as only a few people could cross it at a time. The 300 strong Marathas clashed against the thousands of the Adilshahi army and held them back. The fleets of enemy units kept trying to push past Baji Prabhu and his soldiers but they fought aggressively and pushed them back.

The Marathas were badly wounded, but did not give up before inflicting severe casualities on the enemy. They were waiting to hear the canon boom from Vishalgadh signalling Shivaji's safety. Baji Prabhu Deshpande, severely wounded, died fighting at Ghod Khind resting easy in the knowledge that Shivaji was safe. In memory of Baji Prabhu Deshpande and his brave soldiers, Ghod Khind was renamed **Pawankind** (Sacred Pass). Baji Prabhu Deshpande was paid rich tributes by Shivaji. Even today there are people who trek from Panhalgadh to Vishalgadh remembering the brave few and their contribution to Swarajya.

THINK!!!

What would have happened if not for Shiva Kashid, Bhaji Prabu Deshpande and other Marathas, who bravely sacrificed themselves for their king?
Why did they choose to do so?

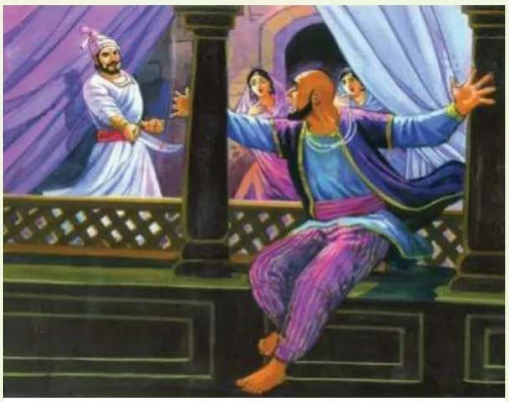
SHIVAJI VS SHAISTA KHAN

After the dramatic death of Afzal Khan, and back to back blows, Aurangzeb appointed his uncle Shaista Khan as the new viceroy of the Deccan Sultanate. In January 1660, with an enormous army of 1,50,000 soldiers, elephants, camels and horses, Shaista Khan paraded

BATTLE OF PAWANKHIND	
When? July 1660 CE	
Where? Kolhapur, Maharashtra	
Who were the combatants?	
Marathas	Bijapur Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Baji Prabhu Deshpande	Siddhi Jauhar
Outcome : 1000s of Adil Shahi soldiers killed, Baji Prabhu Deshpande & few Maratha soldiers martyred	
SIGNIFICANCE : Shivaji escaped capture and continued fight against the Mughals	

into Aurangabad and quickly captured Pune, Shivaji's capital. He seized the Maratha territory and established his residence at Shivaji's palace - Lal Mahal, when Shivaji was away. No Hindu soldier or civilian could leave or enter Pune without applying for permission. Shivaji decided to retaliate by attacking Shaista Khan right in the middle of his own camp. Shaista Khan stayed at Lal Mahal, a big mistake considering Shivaji knew every nook and corner of the palace and its surroundings.

In April 1663, Shivaji infiltrated Pune with a troop of around 200 soldiers, in the guise of a wedding procession. Disguised as people who came to attend the wedding, Shivaji and his soldiers silently entered the Lal Mahal and found their way to Shaista Khan's bedroom. Shaista Khan was alerted in the nick of time by his servants and he jumped through the window to escape. Yet he got 3 of his fingers chopped off by Shivaji. Shaista Khan's son, and his guards were killed. By now Shivaji realized that his enemy was alert and he escaped with his soldiers to Sinhagadh. This covert operation was so well executed that the Mughals started fearing that Shivaji possessed some kind of magical powers. The word spread far and wide and Shivaji came to regarded as a superhero. It was a huge humiliation for the Mughals.


Shivaji cutting off the fingers of Shaista Khan

Shivaji didn't stop with that – he immediately ransacked the rich Mughal trading city of Surat. He plundered the city and captured its wealth. He attacked the Mughals when they were least prepared. Shivaji captured various Mughal ports in Maharashtra following the richest one in Surat. Were Shivaji's attacks always successful? Was he ever captured? Let us read about how Shivaji used even his defeat to his advantage.

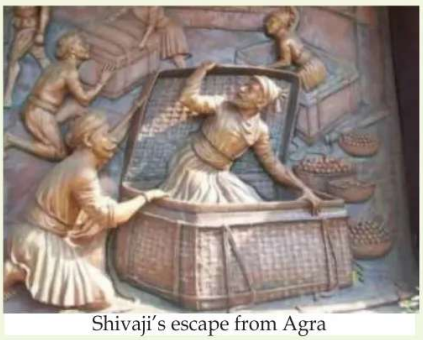
Did Shivaji adopt the same solution for all challenges? He was able to think on his feet and develop innovative solutions, outwitting the enemy each time. Imagine the training given to Shivaji's army, such that they were able to adapt to different strategies!

THINK!!!

CAPTURE AND ESCAPE

The Mughals had many kings of Bharat as their allies and cunningly used them to fight the loyal Bharatiya forces. Enraged by the loss of face for the Mughals, Aurangzeb sent Mirja Raja Jai Singh with a huge army to defeat Shivaji. In 1665, Jai Singh with 1,50,000 soldiers attacked and captured many Maratha forts. This forced Shivaji to sign the **Purandar treaty** on 11 June 1665 where he gave up 23 forts and 4,00,000 Hunas compensation. Even though Shivaji did not want to, his love and responsibility towards his soldiers prompted his surrender.

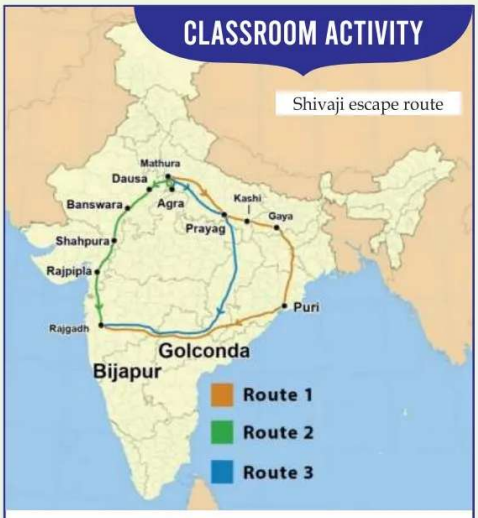
Under Aurangzeb's command, Raja Jai Singh invited Shivaji and his son Sambhaji to Agra. On reaching the Mughal court in Agra, Aurangzeb made Shivaji stand behind the military commanders of his army intentionally disrespecting him. When Shivaji took this as an offence and stormed out of the court, he was then confined under house arrest by Aurangzeb.


Shivaji's escape from Agra

Now Shivaji was far from his home ground, with hardly anyone on his side. He had to escape from the enemy's den, without any resource. Despite the tough circumstance, it didn't take too long for Shivaji to think through an escape plan. This time he appealed to the enemy's ego. He knew that Aurangzeb wanted to break Shivaji's spirit. Shivaji faked severe illness and requested Aurangzeb's permission to send back his followers to Deccan. Aurangzeb fell for the trap and agreed.

Shivaji acted as though he was in his last days and appealed to Aurangzeb for his consent to send daily offerings of fruits and sweets to various sages and fakirs of Agra. This massaged Aurangzeb's ego making him feel that Shivaji was at his mercy. This continued for several weeks. The guards initially checked every shipment moving out of the palace. After many weeks they got slack and stopped checking them. Shivaji took advantage of this slack. One day, Shivaji and Sambhaji hid in two of such shipments and escaped Badshah's palace. Instead of taking the most obvious route back to Pune, Shivaji travelled northwards to Mathura, eastwards to Allahabad, and finally south-westward through Bundelkhand, Gondwana and Golconda and finally to Rajgarh in Pune. The entire journey took him 25 days. Aurangzeb felt embarrassed and crushed on hearing about Shivaji's escape. He regretted this till his death. He kept lamenting to his sons that this negligence would cost them incalculable harm.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY



These are three possible routes Shivaji Maharaj could have taken to reach Pune, according to popular sources. Calculate the approximate distances he would have covered under each route.

Route 1_____

Route 2_____

Route 3_____

FORTS - THE BEDROCK OF SWARAJYA

Shivaji Maharaj firmly believed - "Swarajyache Saar te durg" meaning forts are the bedrock of Swarajya. Shivaji wielded the forts as one giant weapon. He recognised that power in Maharashtra meant control of the forts. Certain traits of the forts, some predating Shivaji, many devised by him, enabled a strong kingdom to rise.

Some of the key features of the Maratha forts are as follows:

- The Marathas built huge water tanks on the forts, enough to serve hundreds of soldiers. Even today, after centuries of neglect, these tanks remain the primary source of water. The tank atop the Alang fort is so extensive, it is difficult to believe human hands built them.
- Shivaji ensured every fort had multiple entry and exit points. While one would be the main entrance, there were other smaller 'chor darwajas' which served like backdoors for making an escape effective. Moreover, for the main entrance, a 'Gau Mukh' arrangement was followed when building the door and its bastions. From a distance, the ramparts of the fort would seem to overlap and thus, conceal the entrance. Inside the forts, the steps were intentionally made of uneven height. In the event of enemies entering the fort, the uneven steps made it difficult for soldiers on horses and those on foot to move swiftly.
- Shivaji also adopted unique means of defence, such as scraping the hill sides to make the hill side nearly vertical and make full use of the natural defences of the fort. This can be seen on various forts, including Rajgadh. Some structures were unique to particular forts. The double wall of Rajgadh, for example. It acted as a double defensive wall and could even trap soldiers in the narrow gap between the walls.



Water tank atop Alang fort



Escape route/Chor Darwaja



Double wall Rajgadh fort

- Of the physical changes, the last but not the least, was the building or maintaining of forts in pairs - Rajgadh and Torna, Purandar and Vajragadh, Lohagadh and Visapur. This served a dual purpose. It provided a readily accessible safe area to a besieged fort and one fort could provide the other with provisions and supplies. For example: The case of the fort of Trimbak, provided back-up resources to Ramsej in northern Maharashtra during the great war with the Mughals. The small fort of Ramsej held on for six years.
- Shivaji realised the importance of having a strong naval force, and therefore he strategically established a navy and forts at the coastline to defend the Konkan side of Maharashtra. Jaigadh, Vijayadurg, Sindhudurg and other such forts still stand to testify his efforts and ideas. These forts also helped as the frontline for sea-trade.

  The Marathas prevailed, primarily, because of the forts. The administration of the forts was dealt with an iron hand with utmost respect for the rules.


Sindhudurg water fort

WINNING BACK SINHAGADH


Tanhaji explaining the plan to reclaim Kondhana fort

The treaty of Purandar in the year 1665 had forced Shivaji to surrender 23 forts including Kondhana. This treaty hurt the pride of the Marathas. Jijabai expressed to Shivaji her wish to recapture the forts from the Mughals. Shivaji thought there was nobody else more capable for this task than his trusted general **Tanhaji Malusare**, a man of iron will who accompanied Shivaji on all his historic battles. The mission to recapture Kondhana fort was very tough and could prove fatal to the soldiers. The fort was under the care of Uday Bhan, an ally of Aurangzeb. Jijabai and Shivaji discussed this with Tanhaji. He was undaunted by the plan and vowed to accomplish the task or die in the battle-field.

In February 1670 CE, Tanhaji set out at night from Konkan and marched towards the fort, accompanied by his army. It was a cold, clear and moonless night. Tanhaji had taken his pet Yashwanti, a ghorpad or monitor lizard, to help him scale the wall of the fort. Monitor lizards are adept in choosing the best route to scale a wall. Tanhaji with a small band of soldiers managed to scale the fort walls. However, their entry into the fort was detected by the Mughals. A fierce fight raged. The 700 soldiers who had accompanied Tanhaji were hoping to enter the fort through the main and side doors. Tanhaji and his brave bunch had to deal with the enemies inside the fort and quickly open the gates of the fort. Uday Bhan's forces were fierce and hampering Tanhaji's progress towards the gates. In a tough fight with Uday Bhan, Tanhaji lost his life. But by then the Maratha soldiers gained entry, killed Uday Bhan and claimed the fort.

The news of the victory was sent to Shivaji, who came quickly to congratulate his friend Tanhaji. When he came to know of Tanhaji's supreme sacrifice. Shivaji broke down and said "We gained the fort but lost the Lion." The fort was renamed as Sinhagadh in honour of Tanhaji. This fort still stands today, as a monument to the friendship of Shivaji and Tanhaji.

THE DAWN OF CHHATRAPATI SHIVAJI MAHARAJ

In 1674 after a long time, Shivaji finally returned to Pune. In June 1674, a grand coronation for Shivaji was held in Raigad earning him the title of Chhatrapati, an independent king. Rajamata Jijabai's dream of Hindavi Swarajya and Guru Samartha Ramdas's vision for Dharma to be upheld, got realized on this day.

SHIVAJI'S PILLAR OF SUPPORT - SAMARTHA RAMDAS


Samartha Ramdas guiding Shivaji Maharaj

Here, it is important to recount a couple of incidents that convey the impact of Samartha Ramdas on Shivaji's life. When invited for the coronation by Shivaji, Samartha Ramdas expressed his inability to attend it. The Guru explained to Shivaji that the attention of people should be on the Chhatrapati on that day, and they should not be distracted by the presence of ascetics like him. The Guru always kept the king rooted through the prosperous and tough times. Once when Shivaji was walking along with Samartha Ramdas, Shivaji remarked that he had provided well for his people. Samartha Ramdas immediately lifted a stone under which there was a frog. He asked Shivaji if he has provided for that frog. Shivaji realised that there was a greater power taking care of all. Presence of a strong spiritual mentor ensured that Shivaji did not rest on his laurels after his coronation. Chhatrapati Shivaji strengthened his power through appointments of trusted ministers and planned an expansion to the south to free the area from the rule of the Qutbshahi and other nizams. Guru Samartha Ramdas truly kept Shivaji grounded in the scriptures through the thick and thin. He established many Hanuman temples and Akhadas or gyms alongside them, to emphasize the need for physical fitness to fight the Islamic forces. Samarth Ramdas created such a fighting force that supplemented Shivaji Maharaj's army.


Coronation of Chhatrapati Shivaji

THINK!!!

Can you guess his age when Shivaji officially became Emperor?

He was 44 years old. He accomplished all the glorious acts without an official title. He had no obligation as a king to his people but his vision was mighty. Shivaji Maharaj's story reminds us that we do not need a title to be an inspiring and effective leader

EXPANDING MARATHA TERRITORIES TO THE SOUTH

Moving through Hyderabad, Srisailam, Gingee, Vellore, and Trichy Shivaji reached Kollidam. He won over the Nayak of Madura and reached Thanjavur. All along the way Shivaji fought his way through to capture the region and their forts or the local ruler surrendered to him. At Thanjavur, he met Venkoji who was ruling the place and demanded his share of the taxes of the region. They were unable to come to an agreement on the splitting of the wealth by which time Venkoji fled the camp. Shivaji appointed administrators to govern the southern region that he had won over. The English, French and Dutch in the region were eager to please Shivaji and sent over many gifts and tributes to him. Having established his ministers in place, Shivaji headed back to Maharashtra. Enroute the regions of Kolar, Sira and Hoskote were taken over by him and he reached Panhala in 1678. By 1679, Shivaji had groomed his sons Sambhaji and Rajaram to govern over different regions of the Maratha empire. By the end of 1679 Chhatrapati Shivaji fell sick and in March 1680 Chhatrapati Shivaji breathed his last. Bharat had lost one of its bravest.

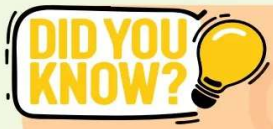
The great spiritual guru Samartha Ramdas wrote:

"Remember Shivaji's image, his daring exploits, his perseverance on this earth
How he spoke, how he behaved, how he endeared himself
Sacrificing all his pleasures, he could gain his ambition , the pain to establish a kingdom, see how it was done
Only when one does more than this, should one be called a man, more than this, what can I write?"

ADMINISTRATION UNDER SHIVAJI, THE LEADER

As a king Shivaji brought in exceptional policies and systems so that Dharma was maintained. Salient features of Maratha administration are :

- Shivaji Maharaj employed members of all castes to maintain balance in the society. He assigned separate responsibilities to each minister. No one held hereditary office positions.
- The Ryotwari system of revenue was followed where farmers became landowners. Previously, the Vatandars (Independent officers) used to collect taxes from the peasants and agricultural workers of the various regions. This led to the peasants being exploited. Shivaji paid the Vatandars directly from the treasury and ensured that the farmers were not charged exorbitant taxes.
- Shivaji abolished rights over the forts that were held by local chieftains. Vatandars were not allowed to raise armies. The army was paid directly from the central treasury. The officers were also sent to different forts on a rotational basis. This was to avoid them being in just one fort for too long and gaining too much power within that fort and region. This avoided creating local power centers and allowed for the officers to move from one region to another instead of being stuck to a fort.
- Ashta Pradhaan-Council of 8 ministers was formed with a Prantpati (head of province). The Kingdom was divided into 4 provinces-each under a Viceroy. Head of each village was called Deshpande or Patel. The Panchayat system was followed. Women were respected and the soldiers were not allowed to capture women from defeated armies.
- Shivaji never discriminated his men on religious basis, he even employed Muslim officers as bodyguards. He treated his loyal set of spies as brothers. In fact, the state took care of the families of the deceased warriors. The 6 divisions of army were-(1) Cavalry-2 types of horsemen (Bargis and Silhadars) (2) Infantry (3) Camel battalions (4) Elephant battalions (5) Artillery (6) Navy



Salt, an important commodity, was manufactured in both Sangameshwar (in the Konkan region) and in Goa (which was ruled by the Portuguese). Goan salt was sold at a cheaper rate. Shivaji Maharaj imposed an import duty on the salt from Goa to bring the price on par with the salt from Sangameshwar.

Your Knowledge Partner

CONCLUSION

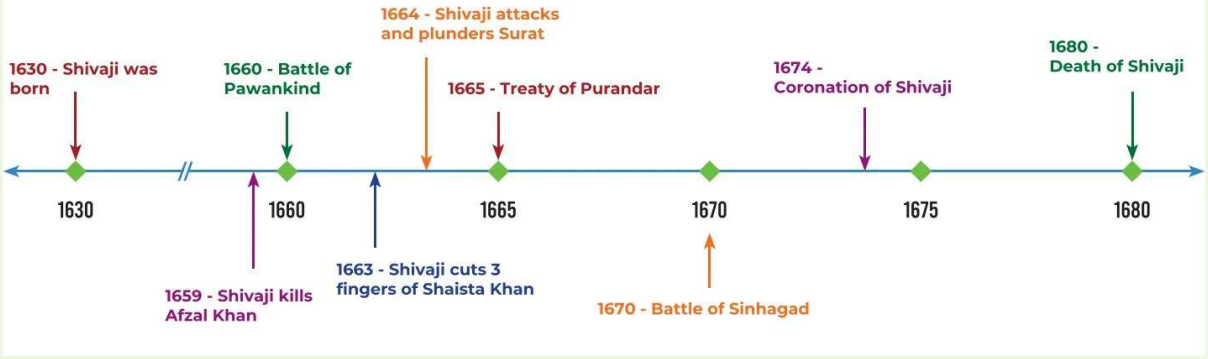
Chhatrapati Shivaji had planned and executed his plan for Bharat. The foundation for Hindavi Swarajya had been laid that will be built on, in the years to come. The changes made to the administrative and military systems greatly benefited the citizens of the Maratha empire. Not granting land in lieu of military service but rather paying them from the central treasury enabled greater control over the military personnel. Shivaji's legacy survived for more than a hundred years after him. The historian Jadunath Sarkar sums up: "Shivaji called the Maratha race to a new life. He raised them into self-reliant people conscious of their oneness and high destiny and his precious legacy was the spirit that he breathed into the race".

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KEYWORDS

- Jijabai, Shivaji
- Hindavi Swarajya
- Adil Shah
- Spy network
- Guerilla warfare
- Afzal Khan
- Pratapgadh
- Wagnak
- Sant Tukaram
- Pawankind
- Baji Prabhu Deshpande
- Shaista Khan
- Raja Jai Singh
- Purandar treaty
- Aurangazeb
- Sambaji, Rajaram
- Forts
- Tanhaji
- Guru Samarth Ramdas

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. The Bhonsales descended from the _____.
   a) Rathores b) Sisodias c) Jalores d) Shahs
2. Shahaji Raje Bhonsale was a key official in the _____
   a) Bijapur sultanate b) Marathas c) Ahmadnagar sultanate d) Berar sultanate
3. True or False:
   Statement A: Dadaji Kondadeo was an early teacher who was a role model for a young Shivaji.
   Statement B: Jijabai inspired Shivaji with the incidents from epics like the Ramayana and Mahabharata.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) A & B are false d) A & B are true
4. The Treaty of Purandar was signed in the year _____
   a) 1663 b) 1665 c) 1667 d) 1669
5. Shaista Khan was appointed as the new viceroy of Deccan Sultanate by _____
   a) Akbar b) Shahjahan c) Aurangzeb d) Adi Shah
6. To meet Afzal Khan, Shivaji hid a dagger and _____ under his armour that he used to kill Afzal Khan.
   a) Gun b) Wagnak c) Khanjar d) Talwar
7. _____ established many Hanuman temples and akhadas that created a fighting force for Shivaji.
   a) Tanhaji Malusare b) Bahirji Naik c) Samartha Ramdas d) Baji Prabhu
8. Shivaji was crowned as Chhatrapati in _____.
   a) April 1675 b) June 1674 c) March 1673 d) November 1676
9. Shivaji and _____ outwitted Aurangazeb and escaped from Agra where they were placed on house arrest.
   a) Venkoji b) Abhaji Sondev c) Nethaji Palkar d) Sambaji

MATCH THE FOLLOWING

Hindavi Swarajya	Ashta Pradhaan
Council of 8 ministers	Deshpande
Cavalry	Chordarwajas
Backdoors	Bharatiya Self-rule
Head of the village	Bargis and Silhadars

Orange House Your Knowledge Partner

ANSWER BRIEFLY

1. How did the Mughals in Delhi govern far away regions like Bijapur and Golconda?
2. What was the role of the Raireshwar temple in Shivaji's life?
3. As a young leader how did Shivaji establish his kingdom and network of forts? Who helped him in this regard?
4. Why did Adil Shah feel threatened by Shivaji and how did he react?
5. Who were the loyal spies of Shivaji?
6. What was the agreement for the meeting of Shivaji and Afzal Khan?
7. Who was Shiva Kashid and his role in Maratha history?
8. What was the impact of the Treaty of Purandar?
9. What was the use of maintaining forts in pairs? Give examples.
10. Describe the role of Samartha Ramdas in Shivaji's life.

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Discuss the role of Jijabai in Shivaji's life.
2. Write a note on the Battle of Pawankind.
3. What was the outcome of the battle of Pratapgadh?
4. Explain the role of Sant Tukaram in Shivaji's life.
5. How did Shivaji enter the Lal Mahal in Pune and humiliate the Mughals?
6. Write a detailed note on the forts established by Shivaji and their importance in establishing the Maratha empire.
7. Who was Tanhaji Malusare? Explain his role in winning back Sinhagad.
8. What were the salient features of the Maratha administration under Shivaji?
9. Explain the expansion of the Maratha empire under Shivaji in the southern regions of Bharat.

CASE STUDY

"Under Aurangzeb's command, Raja Jai Singh invited Shivaji and his son Sambhaji to Agra. On reaching the Mughal court in Agra, Aurangzeb made Shivaji stand behind the military commanders of his army intentionally disrespecting him. When Shivaji took this as an offence and stormed out of the court, he was then confined under house arrest by Aurangzeb."

1. What qualities were exhibited by Shivaji through the above incident?
2. Who was Raja Jai Singh?
3. Explain in detail what followed the house arrest of Shivaji.

REARRANGE THE EVENTS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

1. a) Shivaji is coronated and earns the title of Chhatrapati
   b) Battle of Pawankind
   c) Shivaji is placed under house arrest by Aurangazeb
   d) Shivaji kills Afzal Khan

MAP ACTIVITY

Mark the following places in the map of Bharat.

• Thane • Bijapur • Tuljapur • Pratapgadh • Agra • Sindhudurg • Sinhagad • Sangameshwar • Goa